

# INPUT

Tell the model how to read the values

01 / THE SAS EXAMPLE

```
data test;
  length char_num $8 char_date $9;
  input char_num $ char_date $;
  num_value = input(char_num, best12.);
  date_value = input(char_date, date9.);
  format date_value date9.;
  datalines;
123 15JAN2023
456 01FEB2023
789 31DEC2023
;
run;
proc print data=test noobs;
run;
```

REPORTED TEST SETUP / 21 SEP 2026

Claude Sonnet 4.5 / AWS Bedrock GovCloud

Claude Code 2.1.278 / effortLevel=high / prompt v0.1.0

ATTACH SOURCE OR PASTE IT AFTER THE PROMPT. START FRESH EACH TIME.

WHAT YOU WILL PRACTICE

Make data types and date interpretation part of the request.

Convert character values into numbers and dates. The nine-character date field preserves the full year. Check calendar dates and numeric values; Python need not copy SAS internal date storage.

EXPECTED RESULT

| char_num | char_date   | num_value | date_value |
|----------|-------------|-----------|------------|
| "123"    | "15JAN2023" | 123       | 2023-01-15 |
| "456"    | "01FEB2023" | 456       | 2023-02-01 |
| "789"    | "31DEC2023" | 789       | 2023-12-31 |

date\_value is displayed here as YYYY-MM-DD. SAS DATE9. displays the same calendar dates differently. Quotes mark source strings, not numeric outputs.

REPORTED EXPECTED-VALUE MATCHES

Prompt A 3/3 | Prompt B 3/3

Reference values checked in Python; SAS execution pending.

# Prompt A: leave choices open

High degrees of freedom / Notice the decisions the model makes for you.

COPY THIS PROMPT + THE SAS EXAMPLE

Convert this SAS code to Python.  
Show code in this response. Do not create or run files, or read existing Python files.

REPORTED TRIAL RESULTS / 21 SEP 2026

## All three A runs matched the valid inputs

| Run | Values match | Assertions    |
|-----|--------------|---------------|
| A1  | Yes          | None reported |
| A2  | Yes          | None reported |
| A3  | Yes          | None reported |

SHARED REPORTED CONVERSION METHODS

pd.to\_numeric + pd.to\_datetime  
Date parsing used format='%d%b%Y'.  
Shared methods do not establish identical full responses.

SOURCES: results-20260921.csv; trial-log-20260921.md; analysis-20260921.md

WHY CHOICES REMAIN OPEN

- 1

**Agreement is useful evidence**

All six runs reportedly used the same two conversion functions. The three valid rows matched in both groups.
- 2

**Representation still matters**

A date string can display the right day without being a datetime. Numeric and date types need their own checks.
- 3

**Keep the conclusion in scope**

Three clean inputs do not test invalid values, missing data or other informats. The report cannot establish future reliability.

**ANTI-PATTERN: "MAKE IT LOOK THE SAME"**

Request numeric values and datetime values, then check both meaning and type. Preserve the source strings for comparison.

**Correct-looking text does not prove a correct data type.**

# Prompt B: make the choices explicit

Low degrees of freedom / State the behavior, then ask for a check.

COPY THIS PROMPT + THE SAME SAS EXAMPLE

```
Convert this SAS code to Python using pandas.
Show code in this response. Do not create or run files, or read
existing Python files.

- Recreate char_num and char_date as strings, preserving row order.
- The three inputs are valid; month abbreviations are English.
- num_value: use pd.to_numeric(df['char_num']).
- date_value: use pd.to_datetime(df['char_date'],
  format='%d%b%Y'). Keep this column as datetime values.
- Preserve both source columns and add the two result columns.
- Match calendar dates, not SAS's internal numeric date storage.
- Include assertions for num_value = [123, 456, 789] and for
  date_value formatted as YYYY-MM-DD =
  ['2023-01-15', '2023-02-01', '2023-12-31'].
- Also assert that the result columns have numeric and datetime
  types respectively. Calculate them; do not hard-code results.
- Return one complete script and a brief explanation of the format.
This exercise covers these valid inputs only.
```

WHY THESE DETAILS HELP

- 1 Keep sources and results distinct**  
Keep char\_num and char\_date as strings. Add numeric and datetime columns; preserve the original row order.
- 2 State the date interpretation**  
%d%b%Y means day, month abbreviation and year. The prompt specifies English months and calendar-date comparison.
- 3 Ask for value and type checks**  
B1-B3 reportedly include both kinds of assertions and pass them. The checks cover these three valid inputs.

REPORTED RESULTS / THREE B RUNS

| Run | Values match | Assertions             |
|-----|--------------|------------------------|
| B1  | Yes          | Passed: values + types |
| B2  | Yes          | Passed: values + types |
| B3  | Yes          | Passed: values + types |

CHECK IT YOURSELF  
Compare every value, then inspect both types.  
Use formatted dates for checking; retain datetime data.